Comdg. Asiatic Fleet.

Jan. 7th 1872.

Reporting movements of the vessels of the Fleet. & enclosing extracts from Comdr Kimberly's report of visit to Amoy &c

Asiatic — Hogg

DEPARTMENT
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Two Enclosures

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U. S. S. "COLORADO." (First Rate.)

Flag Ship of Asiatic Fleet.

Wusung Anchorage, 7th Jan. 1872.
below Shanghai.

Sir:

Concerning the movements of the Fleet under my command since the date of my despatch No. 78.- Dec. 5th, 1871:- I have the honor to advise the Department that the "Colorado" sailed from Yokohama on the 7th Dec. 1871. and, taking the outside passage through Van Diemans Strait, south of Kiusiu, arrived at Nagasaki on the 17th.- She sailed from Nagasaki on the 19th and arrived at this anchorage on the 23d of December. It is my intention to sail for Hong Kong on the 9th inst.—

In both Japan and China, affairs are quiet at the present time.

The "Alaska" is at Yokohama. Captain Blake has permission to go to such ports in the vicinity of Yokohama

hama as he may on any occasion deem it expedient to visit:- but is instructed to consider Yokohama as his regular station.

The "Benicia" sailed from Shanghai on the 22nd November, and arrived at Amoy on the 27th after a very stormy passage. From Amoy she sailed on the 8th of December and arrived at Hong Kong on the 10th. Commander Kimberly judged it not prudent to enter the port of Swatow, as directed by his orders, on account of the heavy sea which, at the season of the N.E. monsoon, prevails on the bar and renders it a matter of great risk for a vessel drawing seventeen feet of water to go over.- I enclose extracts from Commander Kimberly's report. The "Benicia" is now under orders to visit Manila and some other ports in the Philippine Islands, to the Southward of Manila, which have lately been opened, and

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at which there is a growing trade.
She is ordered to return to Hong Kong
about the 1st of March.
The "Monocacy" is at this anchorage,
and will remain in this vicinity for
the present.
The "Ashuelot" is also here, having
arrived from Foo-chow on the 2d inst.
Commander Wallace reports affairs
now quiet at Foo-chow, and that the
late excitement against foreigners has
apparently quite passed away.
I have ordered the "Ashuelot" to proceed
to Amoy; — there to receive on board
the U.S. Consul General LeGendre and
with him visit one or two ports in
Formosa, should the Consul desire
to do so. Returning from this
duty, the "Ashuelot" will visit Swatow,
which port the Minister has especially
requested may be visited by a vessel
of war; from Swatow she will go
to Hong Kong.
The "Palos" is at Tien-tsin. — I

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ons without recent advices from Lieut. Rockwell, commanding; I have not heard from any source that there have been any disturbances in that vicinity. The Chinese Government, however gives notice that it is unsafe for foreigners to travel without an escort between Tien-tsin and Peking, on account of the robbers by whom the road is infested.

The "Idaho" Store-ship, is without change at Yokohama.

The Naval Hospital at Yokohama is progressing very satisfactorily toward completion. By this mail I have had the honor to address the Department recommending that an increased sum be allowed for the building of a wing to the main Hospital, and for other purposes specified.

Very Respectfully
Your Obt. Servant.

J. Rodgers
Rear Admiral
Comdg Asiatic Fleet.

Honorable
Geo. M. Robeson.
Secretary of the Navy.

Enclosure with R. Adl Rodgers No. 5 - 2 Jan/ 7-72

— Asiatic Fleet. —

Extracts from Commander Kimberly's letter dated Dec. 10th 1871. -

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- At Amoy, China -

"I found that our Consul had but just arrived from Foo-chow, where he had been to see the Vice Roy regarding the recent incendiary proclamations and which the Vice Roy seems to have been implicated. Gen. Le Gendre, our Consul, from all that I could learn seems to be the leading man at Amoy, not only with the Foreigners Residents, but with natives, and particularly by the Chinese officials who speak well of him, and I think they fear him a little, as he has been the cause of several of them being dismissed for being instigators in the proclamations, inciting the people against the Foreigners."

"My visits were very satisfactory both to the Tau-tai and to the Admiral who holds a very high rank in the Chinese hierarchy.

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ranking with, if not above the Vice Roy. I had received a visit from him at Shanghai, so meeting him again at Amoy our mutual visits were more satisfactory on that account. The Admiral is a self made man, and owes his rank to his bravery and success against the rebels. he seems to be the most liberal Chinese Official that I have yet met with, and seems to have the rare quality (for them) of being candid.

During our stay in Amoy of eleven days, there was but one steamer or vessel of any kind in the port that was American. The majority of the shipping being North German, English, and Siamese. The only Americans there are a few Missionaries, all the American business is conducted by Agents of other Nationalities.

While at Amoy the most peculiar event that occured was an invitation extended to the officers of the vessel and myself to attend a "sing-song" and theatricals performance got up apparently for our especial benifit by the Captain of a

Chinese

Chinese Gun-boat, at his residence on shore. The affair lasted nearly all of one day and was attended by several officers, this is the first attempt made by any Chinese official to entertain us outside of the usual formal official routine and I therefore consider it worth mentioning." ——

"We arrived off of Swatow in the afternoon of the 9th inst. and when the pilot boarded us he informed us that we could not go over that day, and also that the highest water that he would have on the bar at the spring tides on the 11th would be about 19 ft. 6 in.; the ship was drawing 17 ft. 7 in. but the ground swell setting in, caused by the N. E. monsoon was too heavy, and I did not feel that it was prudent with less than two feet to spare at highest spring tide, to attempt the passage of the bar, although the pilot said he could take me over he thought safely," but when he told

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me that they did not bring vessels out of the harbor drawing more than 17 ft. I was confirmed in my opinion that it was not prudent to make the passage over the bar and go in, and therefore I decided not to carry out that portion of my orders, thinking the risk too great, and that you would not justify me in taking it, if the state of the bar had been known to you. The sailing directions are wrong in one particular regarding this port, (that is if the pilot is right), the directions say that a vessel drawing not over 14 or 15 feet can cross the bar at any time of the tide, the low water on the day we arrived was 12 feet. I was also informed by the pilot that the reason why 17 feet was generally the heaviest draft taken out at this season, was because in coming out over the bar the vessels pitched deeper in meeting the ground swell setting in."